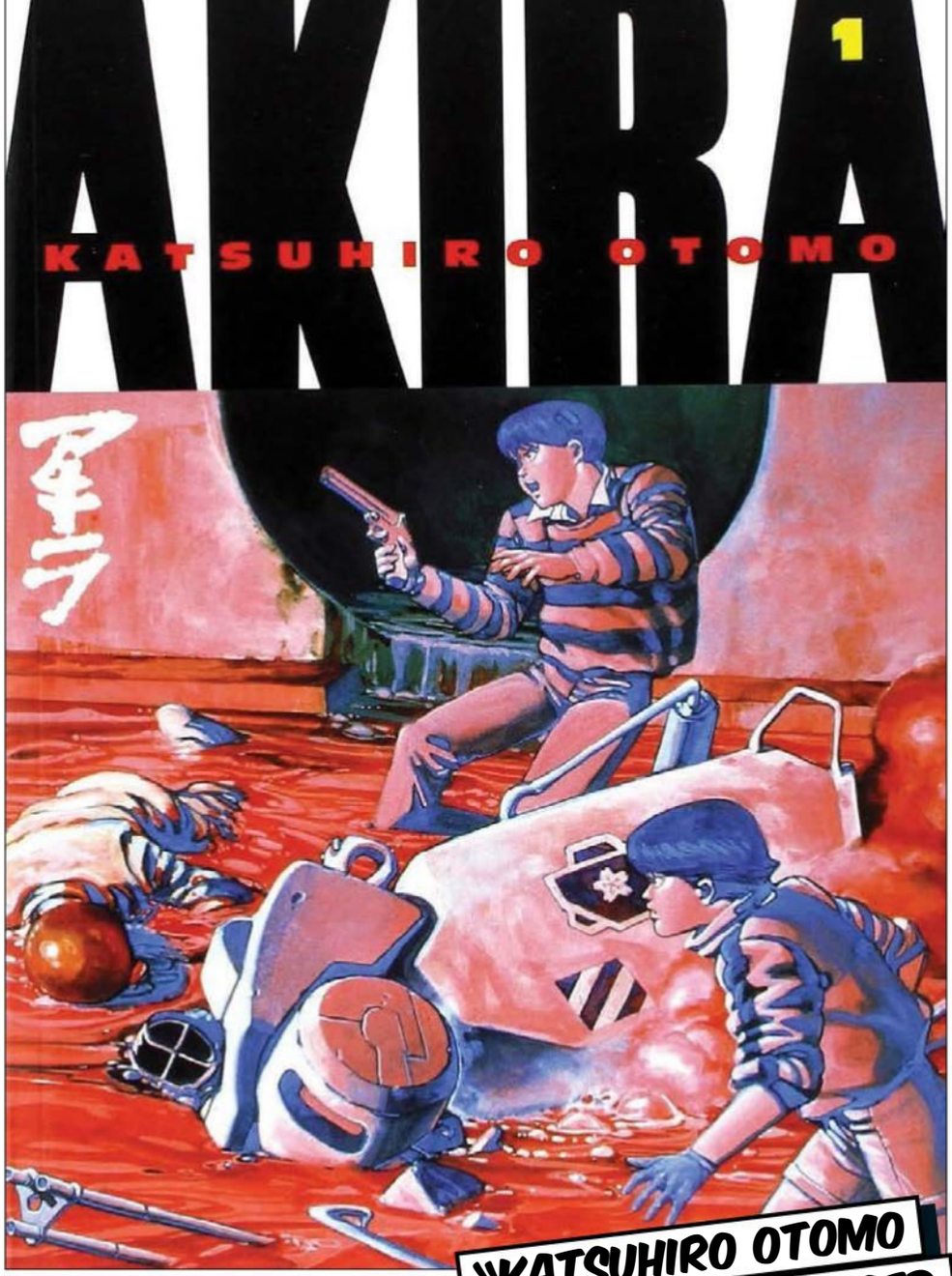
# AKIRA: TETSUO

**Details** **Originally published** Akira: Vol 1 (1984)
**Publisher** Kodansha **Writer** Katsuhiro Otomo **Artist** Katsuhiro Otomo
**Collected in** Akira: Vol 1 **Available digitally** N/A

One of the first manga to be translated in its entirety for the English-language market, this post-apocalyptic cyberpunk series is an absolute classic. First published in the Eighties, Katsuhiro Otomo's work has influenced many contemporary comic artists and *Akira* solidified his reputation as one of the masters of the medium.

Set in the aftermath of a nuclear explosion that destroyed Tokyo and starts World War III, the 2019 Neo-Tokyo is besieged by gang violence and terrorism. Following the fates of Tetsuo and Kaneda, two members of a bōsōzoku motorcycle gang, the book opens with the former awakening his psychic powers as a result of a bike accident caused by the mysterious Takashi.

With a terrifying military presence and anti-government feeling running high throughout, *Akira* uses the futuristic setting and superhuman abilities to explore alienation, government corruption, honour-obsessed military, and an overall study of Japanese culture and establishment.




"KATSUHIRO OTOMO HAS INFLUENCED MANY ARTISTS"

